BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION PHASE

Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

1. Introduction

This document records the brainstorming and ideation activities carried out by the five-member team to define the project scope. The team explored how bulk employee data received as a spreadsheet can be migrated into the ServiceNow platform accurately and efficiently using Import Sets and Transform Maps.

2. Team Details

Member	Name	Role	Responsibility
Member 1	Sornajothika KT	Team Lead / ServiceNow Developer	Custom table creation, overall coordination, GitHub repository management
Member 2	Reshma L	Data Preparation Analyst	Spreadsheet design, sample data creation, Import Set loading
Member 3	Sharmila J	Transform Map Developer	Transform Map, field mapping, coalesce configuration
Member 4	Shridevi M	Test Engineer	Test case design, execution, defect reporting, Transform History validation
Member 5	Suwetha R	Documentation & Reporting Lead	Reports/dashboards, documentation, demonstration video and presentation

3. Problem Statement

Organisations frequently receive employee data in Excel format. Entering this data manually into ServiceNow is slow, error-prone and can create duplicate records. A structured, repeatable import mechanism is required that loads spreadsheet data into a staging table, maps it to the target table fields, and validates the results.

4. Objectives

- Import structured spreadsheet data into ServiceNow using Import Sets and Transform Maps.
- Create a custom target table (Employee Test) with the required fields.
- Prevent duplicate records using the Coalesce feature.
- Verify data integrity using Transform History and reports.
- Help beginners understand the end-to-end data import process.

5. Brainstorming Session Summary

Each member proposed ideas independently for two minutes, after which ideas were grouped and voted on.

Member	Idea Proposed	Outcome
Member 1	Import employee records using Import Set + Transform Map	Selected
Member 2	Use Google Sheets to prepare data and export as .xlsx	Selected
Member 3	Enable Coalesce on Employee ID to avoid duplicates	Selected
Member 4	Validate using Transform History (inserted/updated/ignored)	Selected
Member 5	Create Pie, Bar and List reports on imported data	Selected
Team	Write custom scripts / REST integration for import	Rejected (out of scope for beginners)

6. Idea Prioritisation

Idea	Impact	Effort	Priority
Import Set + Transform Map	High	Low	1
Coalesce for duplicates	High	Low	2
Transform History validation	Medium	Low	3
Reports on target table	Medium	Medium	4
Custom scripting / REST	High	High	Deferred

7. Brainstorm Graphical Chart

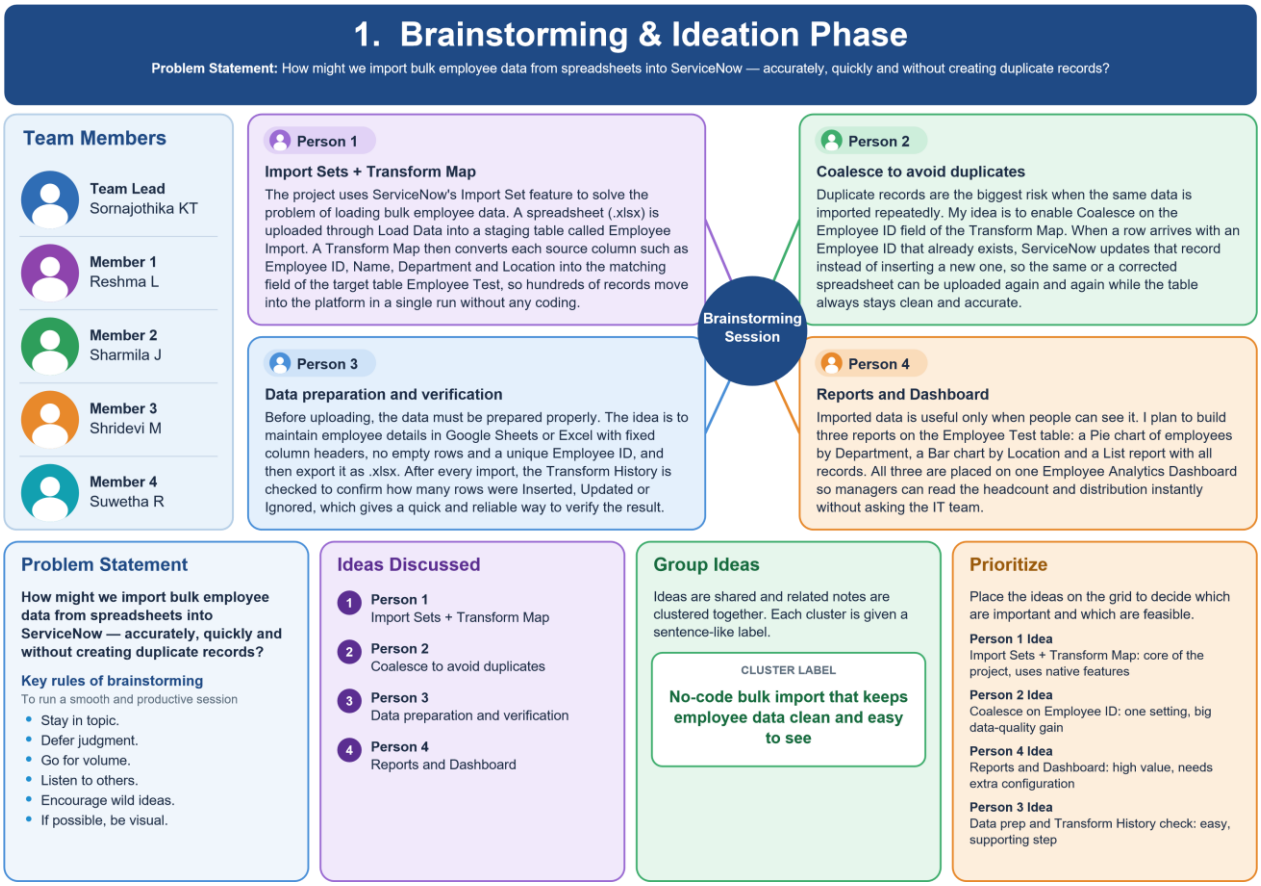
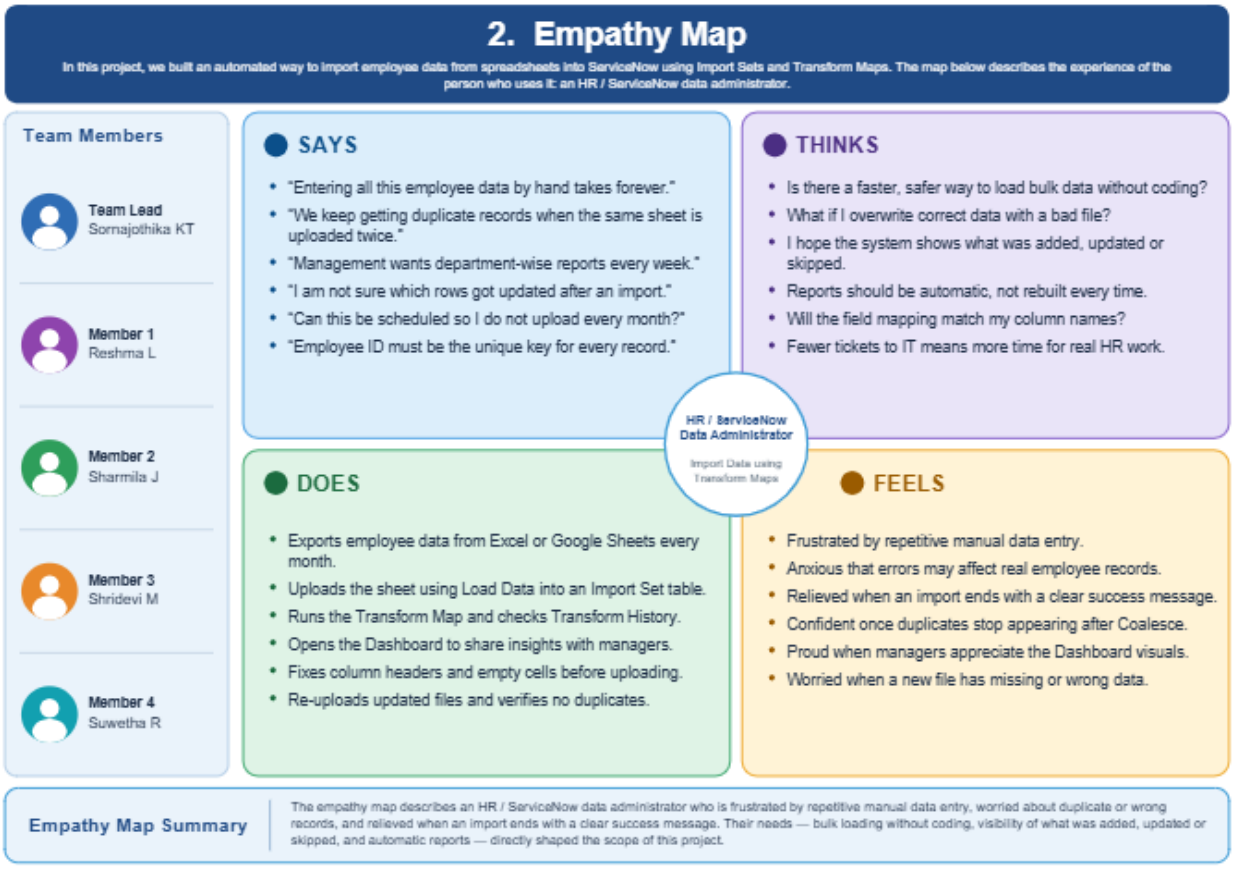


Figure 1: Brainstorm graphical chart (mind map) of the project

8. Empathy Map

User Persona: HR / Data Administrator handling bulk employee onboarding



9. Final Selected Solution

The team will implement an end-to-end data import solution in ServiceNow: prepare a spreadsheet, create the u_employee_test table, load the file into u_employee_import, create and run the, verify results with Transform History and build three reports.